Letter Before Claim

Date: 30 April 2026

To:
Tom Tenant
2 High Street London
E1 2BB

From:
Alice Landlord
1 High Street London
E1 1AA

LETTER OF CLAIM - UNPAID RENT AND ARREARS

Dear Tom Tenant,

Re: Property at 2 High Street London

I am writing to you about the money I say you owe in connection with the above property. This letter is sent in accordance with the **Pre-Action Protocol for Debt Claims**. It sets out:

- the amount claimed;
- what the debt is said to cover;
- how the figure has been calculated;
- what you can do next; and
- what may happen if you do not reply or pay.

1. Summary of the Debt

Rent arrears:	£2430.00
Property damage / other costs:	£380.00
Other charges:	£80.00
Interest to date (8% per annum):	£54.81
TOTAL AMOUNT OWED:	**£2944.81**

Interest continues to accrue at £0.63 per day until the debt is paid in full.

2. Breakdown of the Debt

Rent Arrears

You occupy the property under an assured shorthold tenancy that commenced on 1 January 2024. The agreed rent is £950.00 monthly, payable in advance.

You have failed to pay rent as it fell due. The arrears have accumulated over multiple rent periods. A detailed schedule showing each period, the amount due, what you paid, and the balance is attached as **Appendix 1**.

Property Damage and Other Costs

In addition to rent arrears, you are liable for the following:

- Broken internal door - £200.00
- Professional clean due to excessive staining - £180.00

Other Recoverable Charges

- Locksmith call-out - £80.00

Interest

I am entitled to claim interest on the outstanding rent and costs pursuant to **section 69 of the County Courts Act 1984**. Interest is calculated at 8% per annum from 2 February 2026 and continues to accrue at £0.63 per day until payment.

The interest calculation to 30 April 2026 is £54.81. The full working is attached as **Appendix 2**.

3. What You Must Do Now

You have **30 days from the date of this letter** (i.e., until 30 May 2026) to do ONE of the following:

1. **Pay the full amount owed** (£2944.81) to avoid court proceedings.
2. **Contact me to discuss a payment arrangement** if you cannot pay in full.
3. **Complete the enclosed Reply Form** if you dispute the debt or need time to seek advice.

Payment Methods

If you wish to pay the debt in full, please arrange payment by bank transfer using the details below.

- Account name: Alice Landlord
- Sort code: 10-20-30
- Account number: 12345678
- Payment reference: E1 2BB arrears

If you need to discuss payment, use the contact details shown at the top of this letter.

Payment Plans

If you cannot pay the full amount but can make regular payments, I may be willing to consider a payment arrangement. You must contact me within 30 days with a realistic proposal. Any offer must:

- Clear the arrears within a reasonable time (typically 6-12 months);

- Include ongoing rent payments in full;
- Be supported by evidence of your income and expenditure.

Please complete the enclosed **Financial Statement Form** if you wish to propose a payment plan.

4. Sources of Free Debt Advice

If you are unsure what to do, you can get free, independent debt advice from:

- **Citizens Advice:** 0800 144 8848 or www.citizensadvice.org.uk
- **StepChange Debt Charity:** 0800 138 1111 or www.stepchange.org
- **National Debtline:** 0808 808 4000 or www.nationaldebtline.org
- **MoneyHelper:** 0800 138 7777 or www.moneyhelper.org.uk

These services are free and confidential. They can help you understand your options and, if needed, contact me on your behalf.

5. What Happens If You Do Not Respond or Pay

If you do not respond to this letter within 30 days, or if you do not make acceptable arrangements to pay, I will have no choice but to issue court proceedings against you without further warning.

If I issue a court claim, I will ask the court for:

- the full amount owed (£2944.81) together with **court fees and any recoverable costs**;
- the court fee, which is currently about £205.00;
- continuing interest at £0.63 per day until payment or judgment;
- a County Court Judgment, which can affect your credit record for six years if it is not paid in time; and
- enforcement action if needed, such as bailiffs, an attachment of earnings order, or a charging order.

It is in your best interests to contact me now to resolve this matter.

6. Documents Enclosed

The following documents are enclosed with this letter:

1. Information Sheet for Defendants
2. Reply Form
3. Financial Statement Form
4. Appendix 1: Schedule of Rent Arrears
5. Appendix 2: Interest Calculation

7. Your Rights

You have the right to:

- Seek free debt advice from the organisations listed above;
- Dispute the debt if you believe it is wrong;

- Ask for more information or documents;
- Propose a payment plan if you cannot pay in full;
- Defend any court claim if you have a valid legal defence.

Please do not ignore this letter. If you need time, documents, or debt advice, use the Reply Form and let me know within 30 days.

Yours sincerely,

Alice Landlord
Date: 16 April 2026

IMPORTANT: *This is a formal Letter Before Claim sent under the Pre-Action Protocol for Debt Claims. You should reply within 30 days. If you do not reply or pay, court proceedings may be started without further notice.*